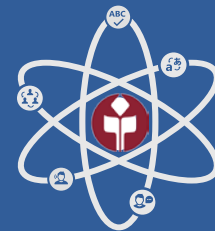


Elevator Pitch



Cultivating a Culture of Entrepreneurship Mindset and Undergraduate Research – CEMUR

Funded by The National Science Foundation's Improving Undergraduate STEM Education: Hispanic-Serving Institutions (HSI Program) Award # 1953751

Introduction

An elevator pitch is a short speech or introduction that describes who you are and what you do and leaves the listener wanting to know more or take action.

Attitude

Creating an elevator pitch is a great way to focus on the value of your project and communicate it to others in impactful ways. It is practiced in business and in startup companies and competitions. It is also a great way to start a presentation and kick-off a discussion with someone that might be interested in what you are doing. Scientist and engineers can struggle with getting their ideas across to others.

Entrepreneurial Mindset: Communication and Collaboration, Initiative & Self-reliance, Creativity & Innovation.

Preparation

Think about your project. Write notes on what value it adds to people or the customer. What impact does it or will it have? Who is most interested in what you are offering?

The steps below are adapted from Alyssa Gregory's, "Elevator Pitch" article in Small Business (www.thebalancesmb.com/how-to-write-an-elevator-pitch-2951690). Read through the article and write down notes and ideas for your elevator pitch.

Process

Step 1: Define who you are.

- Write one sentence about who you are.
- "Hi, I'm a first-generation college student studying STEM so that I can make a difference in the world and help people live closer in balance with our natural resources."

Step 2: Describe your team's research / design challenge / mission statement.

- Write one or two sentences about the research / design challenge.
- "How do you improve the habitat of endangered species?"

Step 3: What problem are you solving?

- Write one or two sentences describing who will benefit from your solution. What is the value you offer to your customers?
- "More biodiversity keeps us breathing. Without oxygen, well you know what happens. Healthier ecosystems improve oxygen production for humans. Knowing the migration patterns of species will help us improve their ecosystems."

Step 4: How is your approach different?

- Write one or two sentences that describes your approach and how it is different or sets you apart from other approaches.
- "We are using LIDAR to characterize the migration of endangered species. This allows high resolution imaging and movements to be accurately analyzed."

Step 5: Ask a question.

- You want to engage your audience and bring them into your conversation, so they share your passion or pain.
- "Are you fond of breathing? Who isn't?"

Step 6: Wrap up with a call to action.

- Write one or two sentences about what the listener can expect to find out more about your project or how they can get involved.
- "Come learn more during the poster session. Our poster is the one with a picture of an endangered California Condor."

Conclusion

Practice, Practice, Practice

Practice the flow of your pitch. Add transitions so it flows well and is conversational and engaging. Aim for 30 to 90 seconds. Don't be tempted to explain every detail. Step out of your scientist/engineer hat and step into your tik-tok hat. Keep it short, memorable, and impactful.

Try it out on your target customer.

Reflect on how you felt and how your pitch was received. What can you improve? Did you get the desired reaction?